What has been happening

A plain account of how this page has changed and why, newest first. The student is invented; the program around her is real and checked, and a page that proposes putting a real student on the open web should be willing to show its working. Each entry says what changed and what it was *for*.

Where it stands

This is a sample, and says so across the masthead. Ruby Calder does not exist. No real student's name, photograph or record appears on the page, and the portrait is drawn rather than photographed for exactly that reason.

The program around her is real and checked. The degrees, their published hour and dollar thresholds, the event names, the officer duties, the record-keeping system and the chapter rating are all sourced. The invented record is set to be internally consistent with the real thresholds, because that is the first thing an advisor would check.

It argues for something. That a sixteen-year-old in agricultural education already has a documented record, and that the reason it never gets seen is that a résumé has no row for any of it.

What has been happening

2 October 2026 — built as a résumé precursor rather than a résumé

Nine answers above, twelve previewed sources in the middle, and a column C about what the page replaces and who decides whether it exists.

The premise is that a first résumé is a bad instrument for a sixteen-year-old: a form designed to list employment, handed to somebody who has not been employed, so the result reads as an absence. The absence is false. A student two years into agricultural education has a documented project, hours logged against published thresholds, competitive events with placings, an office with written duties, and service hours recorded by date. It simply has no row on a résumé form.

One detail is not a coincidence. The invented student holds the office of chapter Reporter, whose written duties include publishing a chapter newsletter or website, releasing news to local media, and serving as chapter photographer. If this idea has a natural home inside a chapter, that is the office it belongs to.

2 October 2026 — the consent question, answered with law rather than assumption

This was the question that held the whole idea up, and it has a better answer than expected.

What such a page carries — a student's name, photograph, participation in an officially recognized activity, and degrees, honors and awards received — is almost field for field what federal education privacy law enumerates as *directory information*. A school may disclose it, but only after public notice of what it designates as such and a reasonable period for a parent to opt out, and an opt-out binds the school.

Neither National FFA nor the state association publishes any policy on putting members' names and photographs online. That is a real gap rather than a failure to find one, and the page says so rather than implying a policy exists. So the page cites the law instead, and states a working rule plainly: written agreement from the student and a parent before anything goes up, the page belongs to the student and moves with them, and either of them can have it taken down at any time without giving a reason. A page that cannot be taken down easily should not go up.

2 October 2026 — three facts that were wrong in the draft

All three were caught in checking rather than in drafting, which is the argument for checking.

The state degree had the wrong name. The draft called it the "Wyoming FFA Degree," by analogy with states that do rename theirs — Texas has a Lone Star Farmer, Pennsylvania

a Keystone Degree. Wyoming does not; it is the State FFA Degree. An invented student with an invented degree name would have been spotted by the first advisor who read the page.

Two event names were wrong and one was in the wrong category. There is no national event called “Ag Mechanics,” and the issues event is a Leadership Development Event rather than a Career Development Event. In fairness this is easy to get wrong: the organization’s own main events page lists all twenty-five events merged together with no labels at all, which is probably why the distinction is so often reported wrongly.

And one constraint nearly produced a dishonest record. Only hours and dollars from the student’s immersion project count toward degree thresholds; the foundational coursework every student does, does not. A record that totaled the two together would overstate a student’s standing. The figures on the page are immersion only.

2 October 2026 — the card, and what the card proved

About a hundred printed cards go with the page. The front carries name, chapter and telephone number; the back carries a square code, the address printed underneath it, and three lines telling somebody who has never used one what to do — including what to do when nothing happens. That last part is usually missing, and a code with no fallback is a dead end for the person most likely to be holding the card: an older rancher, at a sale barn, in bad light.

The first artwork put the address on one line and it ran straight off the edge of the card. That was not caught in the design; it was caught by rendering the artwork and looking at it. It is on two lines now, and the card build refuses to produce artwork whose text crosses the trim.

The useful part is what the failure meant. At a size anybody can read off a card, a path under a shared domain does not fit. So each student wants a short address of their own — about a dozen dollars a year, and theirs when they leave. The card turned out to be the argument for the domain.

Still open

- **No student and no advisor has seen it.** That is the test and it has not been run.

- **The chapter's Gold rating rests on a single source** — a credible trade paper, and still one source, because the association publishes no historical results. One telephone call to the chapter settles it.
- **Nobody has approached either chapter** about any of this, which has been true since the idea was first written down and is still true.
- **The record is copied by hand.** Today a student would retype the figures out of their record book at the end of a semester, which takes a few minutes. Whether it can be exported instead is a question for the chapter and the record-book vendor, not for this page.

Chronicle · Ruby Calder · a US Handbill & Broadsheet page · covering 2 October 2026
Written alongside the working log rather than from it: that log is about implementation, this page is about purpose.

GYR-O = Green · Yellow · Red · and sometimes Orange

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